TOPIC 03 · INTERACTIVE DASHBOARD
LAB 9 THEME · DASHBOARD KPIS & SELECTORS

Lab 9 — Build the Dashboard's Selectors and KPI Formulas

Maps to	LO3: use Gemini to add dropdown selectors and generate the COUNTIFS and AVERAGEIFS formulas that drive a dashboard's KPIs and summary tables, and test that every KPI responds correctly to the selectors
Duration	30 minutes
Tools	Google Sheets · Gemini dropdown actions and formula generation (COUNTIFS, AVERAGEIFS, IFERROR) · OrchidBay_Dashboard_Build.xlsx
Mock data	data/OrchidBay_Dashboard_Build.xlsx
Course	Gemini for Google Sheet (C817) · v2.0
Prompts	https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C817-Gemini-for-Google-Sheet/prompts/#lab-9

Goal

Build the formula layer of an interactive hiring dashboard: two dropdowns (Position, Source) that drive seven KPIs and three summary tables.

What You Will Do

The Head of Talent wants one page that answers 'how is hiring going?' for any role and any source. You will turn two cells into dropdown selectors, then ask Gemini for the formulas: COUNTIFS that treat 'All' as 'every value', a hire rate, AVERAGEIFS for screening score and days to hire, and the funnel, monthly and source tables that the charts in Lab 10 will use. Every KPI is a formula, never a typed number, so it changes when the selectors change - and you test that it does.

What You Will Build

OrchidBay_Dashboard_Build with Position and Source dropdowns in C3:C4, a KPI row (B7:H7) and funnel, monthly and source tables that all respond to the dropdowns

Prerequisites

- Lab 4 (formulas) and Lab 7 (analysis) completed, or comfort with COUNTIFS.
- This lab folder downloaded, including data/OrchidBay_Dashboard_Build.xlsx.

Data note

Use only the supplied fictional Orchid Bay data or information you are authorised to process. Do not paste credentials, confidential business material or real candidates' or employees' personal data into Gemini, the AI function or a Gem unless your organisation has approved it.

Steps

Step 1. Download OrchidBay_Dashboard_Build.xlsx from this lab's data folder. In Google Drive choose New > File upload, open the uploaded file, then choose File > Save as Google Sheets - Gemini works best on a native Google Sheets file. Close the .xlsx tab and work only in the new Google Sheets copy. At the top right, click Ask Gemini (the spark icon) to open the Gemini side panel. Read the About_This_Data tab before you prompt.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
Required state:
File : OrchidBay_Dashboard_Build (Google Sheets copy)
Tabs : About_This_Data | Dashboard | Applications (720 rows) | Jobs | Lists | Prompt_Log
Dashboard : C3 Position, C4 Source, KPI labels B6:H6, tables at B10, E10 and I10
```

Step 2. Turn the two yellow cells into selectors, one action at a time. Then set both to All.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
1) On the Dashboard tab, create a dropdown in C3 with the values from Lists!A2:A10.
2) On the Dashboard tab, create a dropdown in C4 with the values from Lists!B2:B9.
```

Step 3. Click B7 and ask for the core formula. The trick is that 'All' must mean 'any value' - Gemini usually replaces it with the wildcard "*". Insert it: with All / All, B7 must show 720.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
FORMULA:
Create a formula for Dashboard!B7 that counts the rows on Applications (rows 2-721) where
Position in column F equals C3 and Source in column G equals C4. If C3 or C4 is "All", count
every value for that column.
```

Step 4. Ask for the next three KPIs one at a time, clicking the target cell before each Insert. Expect Interviews 61, Offers 47 and Hires 41.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
FORMULA:
1) Create a formula for C7: the same count as B7, but only rows where Interview_Score (column
L) is not blank.
2) Create a formula for D7: the same count as B7, but only rows where Stage (column M) is
Offered or Hired.
3) Create a formula for E7: the same count as B7, but only rows where Stage (column M) is
Hired.
```

Step 5. Now the rate and averages. Format F7 as a percentage and G7:H7 with one decimal place. With All / All: hire rate 5.7%, average screening score 65.5, average days to hire 31.1.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
FORMULA:
1) Create a formula for F7 that divides Hires in E7 by Applications in B7, showing 0 if B7 is
0.
2) Create a formula for G7: the average Screening_Score (column K) for the rows that match C3
and C4.
3) Create a formula for H7: the average Days_To_Hire (column P) for Hired rows that match C3
and C4, showing "-" if there are none.
```

Step 6. Fill the tables the charts will use. The funnel just points at the KPIs. For the monthly table, insert the formulas in F11 and G11, then fill down to row 19. For the source table, insert J11 and fill down to J17. With All / All, June (F16) = 98 and LinkedIn hires (J11) = 11.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ACTION:
Fill Dashboard!C11:C14 with the formulas =B7, =C7, =D7 and =E7.

FORMULA:
1) Create a formula for F11 that counts applications where Month (Applications column D)
equals E11, using the same Position and Source filters as B7.
2) Create a formula for G11: the same as F11 but only Hired rows.
3) Create a formula for J11 that counts Hired rows where Source equals I11 and Position
matches C3 (All means any).
```

Step 7. Test the selectors. Set C3 to Software Engineer (C4 All): Applications 104, Hires 6, hire rate 5.8%. Set C3 to Data Analyst and C4 to LinkedIn: 30 applications and 0 hires, and H7 shows '-' instead of an error. Ask Gemini to check one view, and confirm with the formula.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
ASK GEMINI:
On the Dashboard tab, Position is set in C3. Check the KPI row B7:H7 against the Applications
tab - are the counts and averages correct for that position?

CHECK:
SE hires =COUNTIFS(Applications!F2:F721,"Software Engineer",Applications!M2:M721,"Hired")
```

Step 8. Prompt_Log already lists every prompt in this lab with its step. Ask Gemini to recap the conversation, copy each line into What Gemini did, add How I verified in your own words, and choose Keep, Revise or Undo in the Decision dropdown. Google Sheets saves automatically. Tip: the side-panel history is lost when you reload the page, so insert or copy anything you want to keep.

PROMPT / CHECK — copy and adapt

```
LOG:
List the prompts I sent you in this conversation. For each one, give a one-line summary of
what you did, so I can copy it into the Prompt_Log tab.
```

Sample Prompts

Use these prompts in the Gemini side panel in Google Sheets (or adapt them). Name the tab and columns, state the output, and always verify the result. The same prompts are in sample-prompts.txt in this lab folder.

Copy-ready prompts online: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C817-Gemini-for-Google-Sheet/prompts/#lab-9

#	Purpose	Prompt
1	KPI	Create a formula for the offer acceptance rate: Hired divided by Offered plus Hired, for the selected Position and Source.
2	KPI	Create a formula that returns the most common Source for the selected Position.
3	Selector	Create a dropdown in C5 with the values 2026-01 to 2026-09.
4	Explain	Explain the formula in B7 to someone who has never used COUNTIFS.
5	Check	Which formulas on the Dashboard tab would break if a new Position were added?

Test It

Check	Expected result
Selectors	C3 lists All + 8 positions; C4 lists All + 7 sources.
All / All	B7:H7 = 720, 61, 47, 41, 5.7%, 65.5, 31.1.
Tables	Funnel 720/61/47/41; June applications 98; LinkedIn hires 11.
Software Engineer	104 applications, 6 hires, 5.8%; the COUNTIFS check shows 6.
Data Analyst + LinkedIn	30 applications, 0 hires; H7 shows '-' (no error).

Checkpoint

Lab 10 provides these finished KPI formulas in its own workbook, so you can continue even if a formula here is not working.

Troubleshooting

If this happens	Fix
B7 shows 0 with All / All.	The formula is comparing to the text 'All'. Ask Gemini: 'when C3 is All, use the wildcard "*"'.
Numbers are right for All but wrong for one position.	Check the selector spelling matches Applications exactly - pick from the dropdown, do not type.
No dropdown action, or Gemini's formula doesn't insert.	Dropdown: select C3 > Insert > Dropdown > 'Dropdown (from a range)' > Lists!A2:A10. Formulas: copy the formula shown under 'The formula Gemini should write' on the prompts page and adapt the condition.
#DIV/0! in F7 or H7.	Wrap the formula in IFERROR - ask Gemini to 'show 0 (or -) instead of an error'.
Filling down F11 changes C3 to C4.	The selector references need $ (C3, C4). Ask Gemini to make them absolute.

Challenge

Add an Offer acceptance KPI (Hired / (Offered + Hired)) in I7 and test it for Customer Success Executive.

Reflection

Why must every KPI on a dashboard be a formula rather than a number Gemini told you?